

Content updates in preparation for migrating to DITA

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The main way to identify items that need to be fixed for the DITA migration is by using the [AsciiDocDITA Vale plugin](#). Writers are not yet expected to run this tool themselves yet. The Implementation tiger team is still investigating all Vale rules to ensure that we have clear guidance on what actions to take for each rule. The first table lists all Vale rules and known actions to take.

As we have complete guidance, we are enabling rules in the openshift-docs GitHub repository, so that any future PRs catch issues and avoid introducing additional problems.

There are also some migration issues that need to be addressed that aren't covered by a Vale rule. Those are captured in the second table.

AsciiDocDITA Vale rules and actions to take

The [AsciiDocDITA Vale plugin documentation](#) is the place to see the most up-to-date information about the Vale rules. This page dives deeper into the details and necessary actions to take for each Vale rule for the OCP docs team.

If you encounter a Vale hit on your content, review the details below for the action to take. Some items require writers to take action on their content, and others might be completed by manual or automated updates by the tiger team.

Be aware of these items to avoid and ensure that you do not introduce any of these items into new content.

Note that some guidance is still in progress on several of the rules. Do not make changes to content for rules with incomplete guidance - wait for further instruction.

Vale rule	Problem description	Action to take	Example AsciiDoc update
<code>AdmonitionTitle</code>	Admonition titles are not supported in DITA.	No action required. The tiger team will remove any instances of admonition titles.	Before <pre>1 .Admonition title 2 [NOTE] 3 ==== 4 Test admonition text. 5 =====</pre> After <pre>1 [NOTE] 2 ===== 3 Test admonition text. 4 =====</pre>
<code>AssemblyContents</code>	After the first module <code>include</code>	Ensure that once you start including modules in an assembly, any other	Before <pre>1 = My assembly</pre>

	statement in an assembly, you can't have any content other than more module inclusions or an additional resources section.	content is contained in modules. The only thing that can come after module inclusions in an assembly is a single additional resources section (<code>== Additional resources</code>). NOTE: For now, the <code>.Additional resources</code> sections that occasionally follow module inclusions are okay to keep as well. We will likely address these closer to or during the migration, once we know more about how we want to handle them. You can continue using <code>.Additional resources</code> after module inclusions as necessary in the meantime.	<pre> 2 3 ... 4 5 include::modules/my-module- 1[leveloffset=+1] 6 7 == Another heading 8 9 Some more text. 10 11 [id="additional-resources_my- assembly"] 12 [role="_additional-resources"] 13 == Additional resources 14 ... </pre> After <pre> 1 = My assembly 2 3 ... 4 5 include::modules/my-module- 1[leveloffset=+1] 6 7 include::modules/module-with- that-content[leveloffset=+2] 8 9 [id="additional-resources_my- assembly"] 10 [role="_additional-resources"] 11 == Additional resources 12 ... </pre>
AuthorLine	There must be an empty line between the level 1 heading (=) and the first paragraph, otherwise DITA will interpret the following line as an author line.	The tiger team automated adding an empty line after level 1 (=) headings in modules. Most assemblies shouldn't require an update. The AuthorLine rule was updated to ignore attribute file inclusions as a non-empty line. However, if you do see an AuthorLine hit in an assembly, be careful when adding a blank line, because it can negatively affect the table of contents. Contact the tiger team with any concerns.	Before <pre> 1 = My heading 2 My first sentence... </pre> After <pre> 1 = My heading 2 3 My first sentence... </pre>
BlockTitle	Block titles (.Heading) are not supported in DITA unless they are part of a table, example, figure, or code block. The following block titles are also	Remove any floating block titles that are not part of the approved items. Example solutions: • Remove the heading • Change it to a proper heading (==) • Change it to a lead-in sentence • Do nothing in the title is on a valid content type; the block title will be converted to bold during migration.	Before <pre> 1 .Supported items 2 3 * Example item 1 4 * Example item 2 </pre> After <pre> 1 The following items are supported: 2 3 * Example item 1 4 * Example item 2 </pre>

	allowed in procedure modules: • .Prerequisites • .Procedure • .Verification • .Results • .Troubleshooting • .Next steps • .Additional resources Any other floating block titles are not allowed. They will be converted to bold text during conversion.		
CalloutList	Callouts will not be supported in DITA.	Callouts must be replaced with one of the recommended alternatives listed in the CCS supplementary style guide. See the Callout replacement for OCP docs Google doc for detailed instructions on how to remove callouts in your files and replace them with one of the alternatives. This also includes options for using tools that might help automate callout replacement.	Before <pre> 1 ---- 2 My code <variable_1> <1> 3 Another line <variable_2> <2> 4 ---- 5 <1> My description 6 <2> Another description </pre> After <pre> 1 ---- 2 My code <variable_1> 3 Another line <variable_2> 4 ---- 5 + 6 where: 7 8 `<variable_1>`: My description 9 `<variable_2>`: Another description </pre>
ConceptLink	Links (<code>link:</code>) and cross-references (<code>xref:</code>) are not allowed in concept modules and assemblies unless they are in an additional resources section.	If the link or xref is not important, remove it. For concept modules: • If the module is incorrectly labeled as a concept module, change it to the appropriate module type and leave links as they are. • If the module is truly conceptual, move the link to an additional resources section either within the concept module, or as a trailing <code>.Additional resources</code> item	Before <pre> 1 = My assembly 2 3 This component is based on the link:cool-project.html[Cool open source project]. 4 5 include::modules/my- module[leveloffset=+1] </pre> After <pre> 1 = My assembly 2 3 This component is based on the Cool open source project. 4 5 include::modules/my- module[leveloffset=+1] 6 7 [id="additional-resources_my- assembly"] 8 [role="_additional-resources"] </pre>

		after the module in the assembly, if one already exists there. For assemblies: • If the link or xref would make sense in the <code>== Additional resources</code> section of the assembly, move it there. • If the content is in the body of the assembly to get around our prohibition on xrefs in modules, create a new module to contain that content. ◦ Reference content: move this to a reference module. The link or xref can remain in the module as is. ◦ Navigation content: move this to a reference module. The link or xref can remain in the module as is. ◦ Procedural content: move this to a procedure module. The link or xref can remain in the module as is. ◦ Conceptual content: move this to a concept module. Move the link or xref into an additional resources section (<code>.Additional resources</code>) either within the concept module, or after the module in the assembly, if one already exists there. • NOTE: A module formed from content that was previously in the body of an assembly has an exception to allow xrefs as long as the module is not reused.	<pre>9 == Additional resources 10 11 * link:cool-project.html[Cool open source project]</pre>
ContentType	The <code>_mod-docs-content-type</code> attribute must be set in all modules and assemblies. This attribute is critical for DITA migration.	The tiger team has added missing content types where it was possible to be determined automatically. Eventually, we will split the work across writers/pods to do the rest of the	Before <pre>1 [id="my-module_{context}"] 2 = My procedure heading</pre> After <pre>1 :_mod-docs-content-type: PROCEDURE 2 [id="my-module_{context}"]</pre>

	NOTE: ToolX has confirmed that the content type attribute is not required for attributes files (e.g. <code>_attributes/common-attributes.adoc</code>).	additions that need to be done manually.	<pre>3 = My procedure heading</pre>
DiscreteHeading	Discrete headings are not supported in DITA. Discrete headings are ones that do not appear in the table of contents.	The tiger team has removed all <code>[discrete]</code> tags in core OCP content. This transformed the discrete headings to normal headings that will now appear in the TOC. Refrain from adding new discrete headings. If you come across any in the future, remove them. If a discrete heading was removed and you don't want it to appear in the TOC, change it to some other format, as long as it is still supported in DITA.	Before <pre>1 [discrete] 2 == My test heading</pre> After <pre>1 == My test heading</pre>
DocumentID	All assemblies and modules must have an ID tag immediately above the document title, aka level 1 heading (= My heading).	Add the missing ID above the level 1 heading (= Heading). There are several incorrect ID syntaxes that can cause this rule to fire: - The ID is below the document title - The ID has spaces in it - The ID has characters other than alphanumeric characters Update the ID to use proper syntax.	Before <pre>1 = My document title</pre> After <pre>1 [id="my-document-title"] 2 = My document title</pre>
DocumentTitle	All assemblies and modules must have a document title, or level 1 heading (= My heading) to start the file.	If your file is missing a level 1 heading (= Heading), add it. Snippets are the only content type that do not need to start with a level 1 heading. If your file starts at a heading level lower than a level 1 heading (= Heading), change it to be at a level 1. For modules, also be sure to adjust the	Before <pre>1 == My module title</pre> After <pre>1 = My module title</pre>

		leveloffset of the module inclusion as necessary. If the file isn't a true module or assembly, consider moving into the snippets/ directory and converting it to a snippet.	
EntityReference	DITA supports only these character entity references: &amp; , &lt; , &gt; , &apos; , and &quot; ; Any others are not supported and should be removed.	None. We don't do this in the OCP docs repository.	
EquationFormula	DITA doesn't support LaTeX and AsciiMath formulas	None. We don't do this in the OCP docs repository.	
ExampleBlock	DITA only allows example elements within the main body - not sections, in other blocks, or as parts of lists.	Remove example elements (====) in areas other than the main body. The main case where this happens in OCP docs is for collapsible blocks. Collapsible blocks don't work on docs.rh anyways, so remove them. You can keep the code block, just remove the collapsible example syntax around it. Ensure that other valid instances of example blocks are only in the main body of the topic, not within other elements.	Before <pre> 1 [%collapsible] 2 ==== 3 [source,yaml] 4 ---- 5 Sample code block 6 ---- 7 ===== </pre> After <pre> 1 [source,yaml] 2 ---- 3 Sample code block 4 ---- </pre>
LineBreak	Forced line breaks are not supported in DITA.	Remove the line break syntax (+). Possible alternatives: - Remove the line break and allow the text to run together on the same line. - Add a blank line between lines. - Put the text into bullets.	Before <pre> 1 Some text + 2 Some more text </pre> After <pre> 1 Some text 2 Some more text </pre>

MismatchedId	The opening and closing quote in a custom ID ([id="..."] or [id='...']) must match. Migration tooling can mishandle IDs where one side uses a double quote and the other a single quote, or where a quote is missing on one side.	Fix the ID so that it has double quotes on both sides. Example: [id="your-anchor-id"] Do not mix quote types (e.g. [id="anchor-id'] or [id='anchor-id"]) and do not leave one side unquoted when the other is quoted.	Before <pre>1 [id="configuring-alert-notifications'] 2 = Configuring alert notifications</pre> After <pre>1 [id="configuring-alert-notifications"] 2 = Configuring alert notifications</pre>
NestedSection	Level 3 headings (===) and deeper are not supported for the DITA migration. Only level 1 (=) and level 2 (==) headings are allowed in files.	Either: - Restructure your content to no longer go 3 levels deep in a file - Move your 3+ level deep headings to separate modules and include them in the assembly NOTE: Keep in mind that cross-references (xrefs) are still not allowed in modules in most cases. However, we are making an exception for release notes modules, as long as they are only ever included from one assembly. More guidance around modularizing release notes is coming.	Before <pre>1 == Release notes for MyOperator 1.4.0 2 3 ... 4 5 === New features and enhancements</pre> After <pre>1 == Release notes for MyOperator 1.4.0 2 3 ... 4 5 include::modules/my-op-features[leveloffset=+2]</pre>
PageBreak	Forced page breaks are not supported in DITA.	No action required. The tiger team will remove any instances of force page breaks.	Before <pre>1 Test text 2 3 <<<</pre> After <pre>1 Test text</pre>
RelatedLinks	<i>Additional resources</i> items, which will map to the <code><related-links></code> DITA element, can only contain links and must be in a	When adding or modifying content, take the following actions for links in additional resources sections: - Format additional resources as an unordered list - Remove lines that do not contain a link or a cross reference	Before <pre>1 * link:https://test-external-amazon-site.com/test.html[Some test page title] (AWS documentation) 2 * For more information, see xref:../directory-name/assembly-name.adoc#anchor-id_context-id[My sample xref]. 3 * For more information about this and that, see the</pre>

	bulleted list. They cannot contain any extra text surrounding the link.	- Remove any text that precedes or follows a link or a cross reference - If the text outside the link text is important, move it to a valid location - If appropriate, you can move text outside the link text to inside the link text (such as for noting external documentation sites) For existing content that is not being worked on, the tiger team plans to automate the removal of this text and send the results to the writing team for review and remediation.	<pre>link:https://test-site.com/v1/documentation/api/la test/index.html[Test API documentation].</pre> After <pre>1 * link:https://test-external- amazon-site.com/test.html[Some test page title (AWS documentation)] 2 * xref:../directory- name/assembly-name.adoc#anchor- id_context-id[My sample xref] 3 * link:https://test- site.com/v1/documentation/api/la test/index.html[Test API documentation]</pre>
ShortDescription	All modules (concept, procedure, and reference) and assemblies must have a short description. The short description must follow DITA requirements.	See the Short descriptions for OCP docs Google doc for detailed instructions on how to update your files to ensure they include a proper short description.	Before <pre>1 Sample first paragraph. Some other text. 2 3 More text later on.</pre> After <pre>1 [role="_abstract"] 2 Rewritten first paragraph to be an effective short description. 3 4 Additional introductory content that can stand on its own.</pre>
SidebarBlock	DITA doesn't support sidebar content.	None. We don't do this in the OCP docs repository.	
TableFooter	Table footers are not supported in DITA.	No action required. The tiger team will remove any instances of table footers.	Before <pre>1 [options="header,footer"] 2 ===</pre> After <pre>1 [options="header"] 2 ===</pre>
TaskContents	All procedure modules must contain the .Procedure heading.	If the module is a procedure module, add in the missing .Procedure heading before the steps. If the module is incorrectly designated as a procedure module, change the <code>_mod-docs-content-type</code> attribute to <code>CONCEPT</code> or <code>REFERENCE</code>.	Before <pre>1 = My procedure 2 3 ... 4 5 . Step 1 6 . Step 2</pre> After <pre>1 = My procedure 2 3 ... 4 5 .Procedure 6 . Step 1</pre>

7 . Step 2			
TaskDuplicate	DITA only supports one instance of approved block titles in task topics/procedure modules.	Ensure that your procedure module only uses one instance of each of the block titles from the approved list: • .Prerequisites • .Procedure • .Verification • .Results • .Troubleshooting • .Next steps • .Additional resources This Vale hit is often because there is more than one procedure in a procedure module. In this case, move the content to a separate procedure module or combine them into a single procedure. Otherwise, remove any duplicate block titles. Do not just change the block title to bold text to simulate a heading.	Before <pre> 1 = My procedure 2 3 ... 4 5 .Procedure 6 ... 7 8 .Procedure 9 ... </pre> After <i>Procedure module 1</i> <pre> 1 = My procedure 2 3 ... 4 5 .Procedure 6 ... </pre> <i>Procedure module 2</i> <pre> 1 = My other procedure 2 3 ... 4 5 .Procedure 6 ... </pre>
TaskExample	DITA only allows one example element in a procedure module.	Remove extra example elements (====) so that there is only one instance in a procedure module. The main case where this happens in OCP docs is for collapsible blocks. Collapsible blocks don't work on docs.rh anyways, so remove them. You can keep the code block, just remove the collapsible example syntax around it. Ensure that other valid instances of example blocks only have a single instance per procedure module.	Before <pre> 1 [%collapsible] 2 ==== 3 [source,yaml] 4 ---- 5 Sample code block 6 ---- 7 ==== </pre> After <pre> 1 [source,yaml] 2 ---- 3 Sample code block 4 ---- </pre>
TaskInclude	An <code>include::</code> directive appears inside the Procedure section of a procedure module. DITA 1.3 allows only one <code><steps></code> elem	Verify that the directive evaluates to a single ordered or unordered list. NOTE: A procedure that is fully compliant but contains an include statement in its steps will always trip this rule. You do not need to clear the	Before <pre> 1 .Procedure 2 . Log in to the console. 3 . Navigate to Settings > Components. 4 include::snippets/additional-steps.adoc[] </pre> After <pre> 1 .Procedure 2 . Log in to the console. </pre>

	ent per task topic, and Vale cannot inspect the contents of included files to verify this constraint.	warning for a topic to be considered acceptable for migration.	<pre> 3 . Navigate to Settings > Components. 4 . Select the component and click Configure. 5 . Click Save. </pre>
TaskSection	DITA does not allow sections (==) in task topics/procedure modules. NOTE: Sections (==) are allowed in concept and reference modules.	If a separate section is needed in a procedure module, move that content to a separate module and include it in the assembly. Or, consider whether it can be moved into the procedure's steps.	Before <pre> 1 = My procedure 2 3 ... 4 5 .Procedure 6 ... 7 8 == Some subsection 9 10 More content </pre> After <i>Procedure module</i> <pre> 1 = My procedure 2 3 ... 4 5 .Procedure 6 ... </pre> <i>Separate module</i> <pre> 1 == Some subsection 2 3 More content </pre>
TaskStep	DITA only allows a set of ordered or unordered steps for the procedure in a task topic/procedure module	For procedure modules, if you have anything after your .Procedure heading that is not in an ordered or unordered list, it must be moved. If the content is unnecessary, remove it. If the content is above the steps, move it into the introductory content above the .Procedure and .Prerequisites headings. If the content is below the steps, either: - Move the content into a procedure step - Add it as a list continuation after the last step. - Move the content into a valid block title below the steps (.Next steps/.Results/.Troubleshooting/.Additional resources)	Before <pre> 1 = My procedure 2 3 ... 4 5 .Procedure 6 7 [TIP] 8 ==== 9 Some tip. 10 ==== 11 12 * Step 1 13 14 You can now do this. </pre> After <pre> 1 = My procedure 2 3 ... 4 5 [TIP] 6 ==== 7 Some tip. 8 ==== 9 10 .Procedure 11 12 * Step 1 13 14 .Results 15 16 You can now do this. </pre>

TaskTitle	DITA only supports approved block titles in task topics/procedure modules.	Ensure that your procedure module only uses block titles from the approved list: • .Prerequisites • .Procedure • .Verification • .Results • .Troubleshooting • .Next steps • .Additional resources Do not use any other block titles. Remove the headings and adjust your content as necessary. For example, move the content to a separate module, incorporate it into the existing procedure steps or add it to an approved block title. Do not just change the block title to bold text to simulate a heading.	Before <pre> 1 = My procedure 2 3 .Procedure for doing task 4 ... 5 6 .Verifying the task 7 ... </pre> After <pre> 1 = My procedure 2 3 .Procedure 4 ... 5 6 .Verification 7 ... </pre>
ThematicBreak	Thematic breaks (horizontal rules) are not supported in DITA.	No action required. The tiger team will remove any instances of thematic breaks.	Before <pre> 1 Test text 2 3 '' </pre> After <pre> 1 Test text </pre>

Additional migration considerations

The following table lists additional items to consider for the DITA migration that aren't captured by Vale rules.

Note that some guidance is still in progress on several of the items. Do not make changes to content for rules with incomplete guidance - wait for further instruction.

Problem description	Action to take	Example AsciiDoc update
There must be an empty line between include statements, to ensure that end of one file doesn't run into the next file and fail to render AsciiDoc elements properly.	No action required. The tiger team will automate adding an empty line after include statements.	Before <pre> 1 include::modules/module-1.adoc 2 include::modules/module-2.adoc </pre> After <pre> 1 include::modules/module-1.adoc </pre>

		2 3 include::modules/module-2.adoc
There must be an empty line between include statements, to ensure that end of one file doesn't run into the next file and fail to render AsciiDoc elements properly.	No action required. The tiger team will automate adding an empty line after include statements.	Before 1 include::modules/module-1.adoc 2 include::modules/module-2.adoc After 1 include::modules/module-1.adoc 2 3 include::modules/module-2.adoc
Floating paragraphs or admonitions within procedure steps are not supported.	Pending further discussion. Three options available: Floating text must be 1) linked to a step, 2) added to the introductory content before the procedure steps, or 3) placed under a .Results title if at the end of a procedure and indicating the outcome of the entire procedure.	
Commented-out text is not captured in DITA. All modules and assemblies that have helpful reminders or info for other writers in the form of commented-out text will lose those notes upon migration.	No action required. Commented-out text will strip out automatically during conversion. The tiger team has decided against any doing a large-scale effort to search for important comments to capture. If, during a CQA, you notice commented-out text that is critical to keep or take action on, you can note that in the future remediation work spreadsheet attached to your CQA's epic. Also note that GitHub will still exist as a reference, should you ever need to go back and look at comments in a file's original AsciiDoc source.	
Missing underscores in module IDs. Module IDs require an underscore (_) in front of the {context} attribute	A repo sweep was performed to add all missing underscores and update any impacted links that break to match. In the future, ensure that all IDs use an underscore.	Before 1 [id="update-service-uninstall{context}"] After 1 [id="update-service-uninstall_{context}"]

	☒ OSDOCS-15679: Sweep the repo for missing underscores in anchors CLOSED	
Internal <code>xref</code> links that do not comply with OpenShift documentation guidelines: internal <code>xref</code> links in modules The use of <code>xref</code> links in modules is not supported by our current tooling and internal inline links from concept and reference topics will not be supported in DITA.	Move any <code>xref</code> links in modules to a trailing <code>.Additional resources</code> section in any assembly that includes the module.	Before (xref in a module) <pre>1 For more information, see xref:../&lt;path>/assembly.adoc#module-ID_assembly-context[Link text].</pre> After (adding the xref in the assembly after the module inclusion) <pre>1 include::modules/my- module.adoc[leveloffset=+2] 2 3 [role="_additional-resource"] 4 .Additional resources 5 6 * xref:../&lt;path>/assembly.adoc#module-ID_assembly-context[Link text]</pre>
DITA does not allow attribute references in links. A retired Vale rule (<code>LinkAttribute</code>) used to catch these instances, but the ToolX team decided that the effort it would take to fix these instances was too high for the benefits.	No action is currently required, though there might be in the future closer to migration. However, if you encounter an attribute in a link that is trivial to remediate while doing other work, convert it to a static link. Even though the rule is retired, fewer attributes in links will mean less work for us later.	Before <pre>1 https://docs.redhat.com/en/docmentation/product-name/{product-version}/html-single/book-name/index</pre> After <pre>1 https://docs.redhat.com/en/docmentation/product-name/latest/html-single/book-name/index</pre>
Automatically generated API documentation.	Pending further discussion.	
Assemblies that contain many cross-references (xrefs) that act as navigation to other areas of the docs. The landing pages are often named <code>index.adoc</code>.	Pending further discussion. We need to investigate more on what to do with these files. We are tracking this investigate with OSDOCS-17637. For now, don't try to modularize these files during CQAs (because xrefs are not allowed in modules for anything other than release notes files). Leave the content in the assembly and we will come back and address all of these files at the same time.	

